

We Value Your Feedback

Flyxion

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The transaction fails, the page errors, the call drops, and before the failure has finished registering, a new window opens to ask how the experience went. Five stars, one star, a slider, an emoji face ranging from delighted to furious, arranged with the same visual care given to the feature that just broke, because in a real sense this screen is the feature. It was tested. It was scheduled to appear exactly here, at the moment of maximum frustration, because frustration is when people are most willing to type something honest and specific, and specific honest complaints, it turns out, are valuable, just not to the person supplying them.

Rate the interaction, and the interaction ends. Nothing about the failure gets fixed as a condition of the rating being accepted; the one star is received the same way the five star would have been, filed, aggregated, folded into a dashboard that someone reviews in the same posture they'd review any other metric trending in the wrong direction, not as a person's afternoon ruined but as a data point contributing to next quarter's retention model. The dissatisfaction was not a problem to be solved. It was an input, gathered at the exact moment it was most information-rich, and the gathering itself was treated as sufficient action, the transaction complete not because anything was repaired but because a rating had been successfully logged.

Somewhere in this arrangement is a genuinely useful signal, the same way somewhere in a strip mine is genuine ore. The trouble is what "valuing" feedback has come to mean in practice: not that it changes what happens to you, but that it changes what happens to the next model trained on people like you, a distinction the survey screen is careful never to draw, because "we collected your dissatisfaction" tests worse than "we value your feedback," even though the first sentence is the only one of the two that's actually true.